

Neural Networks

Mathematics of AI - RPTU Kaiserslautern

WiSe 25/26

Topics of the lecture

- Neural Networks
 - MLP in `scikit-learn`
 - `pytorch`
 - NN training (variants and optimizers)
 - More complex networks (LeNet)

MLP in sklearn

As for previous methods, you can use a sklearn classifier:

```
MLPClassifier(  
    hidden_layer_sizes=(10,10,), # or (10,...  
    activation='relu', # or `logistic`, `tanh`  
    solver='sgd', # or `adam` or `lbfgs`  
    alpha=1e-3, 3 l2 regularization  
    batch_size=32, # more on this later  
    learning_rate_init=1e-3, # learning_rate_init  
    ...  
)
```

MLP in pytorch

In sklearn, you don't have too much possibility to define custom networks (e.g., to operate on images).

Those networks should be manually implemented, as they can be very domain-specific. pytorch is a library for simplifying this process.

In notebook `1_MLP_torch.ipynb` you find a walkthrough on how to implement a MLP using torch.

NN training

Training of a neural network :

- evaluate model on a set (X, y) to obtain $\hat{y}$
- calculate loss $(\mathcal{L}(\hat{y}, y))$
- compute gradient of loss w.r.t parameters $\nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}$
- improve the parameters

$$\theta^{(i+1)} = \theta^{(i)} - \alpha \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}$$

Variants

In notebook `2_stochastic_gradient_descent.ipynb`, we will explore variants of SGD and optimization algorithms.

Variants:

- SGD : Let the set be one sample at a time
- Mini-batch : Let the set be “some” samples (not all)
- GD : Calculate gradient on the entire data set

Optimizers

Different optimizers can be used to update the parameters.

For example, momentum can be added:

$$v^{(t+1)} = \mu v^{(t)} - \alpha \nabla_{\theta} \mathcal{L}(\theta^{(t)})$$

$$\theta^{(i+1)} = \theta^{(i)} - v^{(t+1)}$$

and more (next semester's topic).

See [this visualization](#) and [and this comparison](#).

LeNet in pytorch

Notebook `3_lenet_torch.ipynb` contains an implementation of LeNet, to be trained on the MNIST dataset.

This notebook is more resource-intensive, and downloads a large dataset from the internet. **Make sure to delete the dataset if you don't need it anymore.**